

Problem 5 (20 points). Here are some sentences in Noonni that were spoken on different days of the Noonni “week” and their English translations:

spoken on **Bvutfu**

1. fɔ̀gò cí nú bvúmbòn.
me ncí nò: ntɔ̀ fòwǎy bvúmbòn.
2. wò nú yú: cóŋ kèŋkfǔ bvúsòw.
3. kwɔ̀:n nú bóy fí me bvúzhí.

*Yesterday was **Bvumbon**.*

*On **Bvumbon**, I came to the market.*

*On **Bvusɔw**, you(sg) will steal the yam.*

*On **Bvuzhi**, the woman will help me.*

spoken on **Bvusɔw**

4. wvù tò nò: bɔ̀ŋ ɣwà bvũkã:.
5. fò shě ntfǔ: nú bvútfǔ.
me nú mbóy ncáw mutù bvútfǔ.
6. wvù bê: yò kwɔ̀:n èbèn.
7. wò tò nò: yòw cǔŋ.

*On **Bvũka**, he found the book.*

*The day after tomorrow is **Bvutfu**.*

*On **Bvutfu**, I will choose the car.*

Today, he killed the woman.

You(sg) heard the thief a long time ago.

spoken on **Bvukema**

8. ntfǔ: nú bvũkã:dèn.
cǔŋ nú bóy bóy bèsèn bvũkã:dèn.
9. me mbê: ncáw ɣwà èbèn.
10. dièmsɛn nú yén wvù lě.
11. kefwé cí nú bvũkã:.

*Tomorrow is **Bvũkaden**.*

*On **Bvũkaden**, the thief will find us.*

Today, I chose the book.

The man is about to see him.

*The day before yesterday was **Bvũka**.*

spoken on **Bvũka**

12. me nú nfí dièmsɛn.
13. kwɔ̀:n cí nò: yèn wáy é bvútfǔ.
14. bèsèn nú gé: cóŋ mutù èbèn.
15. bó nò: yèn me lé fòwǎy.

I am about to help the man.

*On **Bvutfu**, the woman saw the market.*

Today, we will steal the car.

They saw me at the market just now.

(a) Translate into English:

spoken on **Bvũkaden**

16. bvúsòw nú fò shě ntfǔ:.
17. me nú ɣgé: nyén kèŋkfǔ lé èbèn.
18. wvù tò nò: yèn bèsèn ẽ bvúmbòn.
19. bèsèn nú bóy tó fòwǎy bvúzhí:dèn.

(b) The first day of the Noonni week is **Bvutfu**. What is the order of the Noonni days?

(c) Translate into Noonni:

spoken on **Bvumbon**

20. *On **Bvusɔw**, I helped the man.*
21. *The thief stole the yam just now.*
22. *On **Bvũkaden**, I will hear the car.*
23. *Today, the woman will kill the man.*
24. *Today, the man saw you(sg).*

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△ Nooni belongs to the Beboïd group of the Atlantic-Congo family. It is spoken by approx. 40,000 people in Cameroon.

ɛ and ɔ are vowels. ŋ, sh, y and zh are consonants. The mark : indicates that the vowel is long. The superscript marks denote tones: ´ high, ˆ falling (high ↘ low), ˜ falling (middle ↘ low), ˘ low, ˆ rising (low ↗ middle), ˙ rising (low ↗ high); if none are present, the syllable has middle tone.

Yam is the edible tuber of the tropical plant of the same name.

—*Samuel Ahmed*